

HIDDEN GEMS

A YouTube Discovery Platform Initiative

Process Map

Hidden Gems — Niche Creator Discovery Platform

Business Process Maps (Swimlane / Cross-Functional)

Project	Hidden Gems Discovery Layer (YouTube)
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Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description of Change
0.1	2026-07-02	Business Analyst	Initial process discovery with Creator Studio & Recommendations teams
1.0	2026-07-14	Business Analyst	Baselined swimlane diagrams for BRD/FTRD alignment

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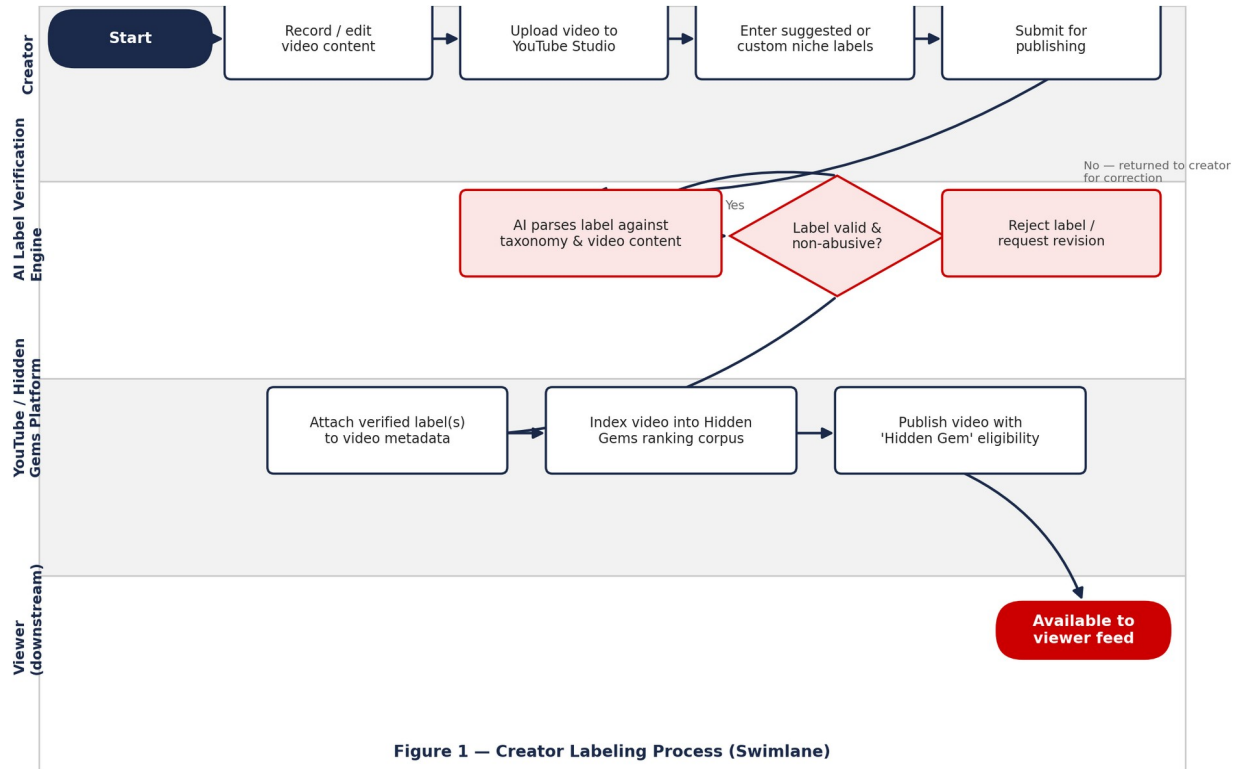
1. Purpose and Notation

This document maps the primary business processes underpinning Hidden Gems using cross-functional (swimlane) flowcharts. Each lane represents a distinct actor or system responsible for the steps within it; arrows indicate control flow, and diamonds indicate decision points. These maps complement the Business Requirements Document (BRD) and Functional & Technical Requirements Document (FTRD) by showing how requirements translate into end-to-end operational flow.

Symbol	Meaning
Rounded terminal (filled)	Process start or end point
Rectangle	A discrete process step or task
Rectangle (shaded)	An automated / AI-driven decisioning or scoring step
Diamond	A decision point with two or more outcomes
Swimlane	Groups steps by the actor or system that owns them

2. Process Map 1 — Creator Labeling Process

This process begins when a creator produces content and ends when a labeled video becomes eligible for the viewer-facing discovery surface. It spans the Creator, the AI Label Verification Engine, and the YouTube/Hidden Gems platform.



2.1 Step Narrative

1. Creator records/edits video content and uploads it to YouTube Studio.
2. Creator enters suggested or custom niche labels during the upload flow (FR-M1-01-03).
3. Creator submits the video for publishing.
4. The AI Label Verification Engine parses each submitted label against the approved taxonomy and the video's content signals (FR-M2-01).
5. Decision — Is the label valid and non-abusive? If No, the label is rejected/returned to the creator for correction with a stated reason (FR-M2-02) and the flow returns to Step 2. If Yes, processing continues.
6. The platform attaches verified label(s) to the video's metadata (FR-M1-06).
7. The platform indexes the video into the Hidden Gems ranking corpus (FR-M5-01).
8. The platform publishes the video with Hidden Gems eligibility, making it available to the viewer discovery surface.

Exception handling: Borderline verification outcomes that are neither a clear pass nor a clear fail are routed to the human moderation queue (Process Map 3) rather than auto-rejected.

3. Process Map 2 — Viewer Discovery & Attribution Process

This process begins when a viewer opens YouTube and ends when a creator receives attributed traffic and/or revenue from the interaction. It spans the Viewer, the Hidden Gems Recommendation Engine, the YouTube platform, and the receiving Creator.

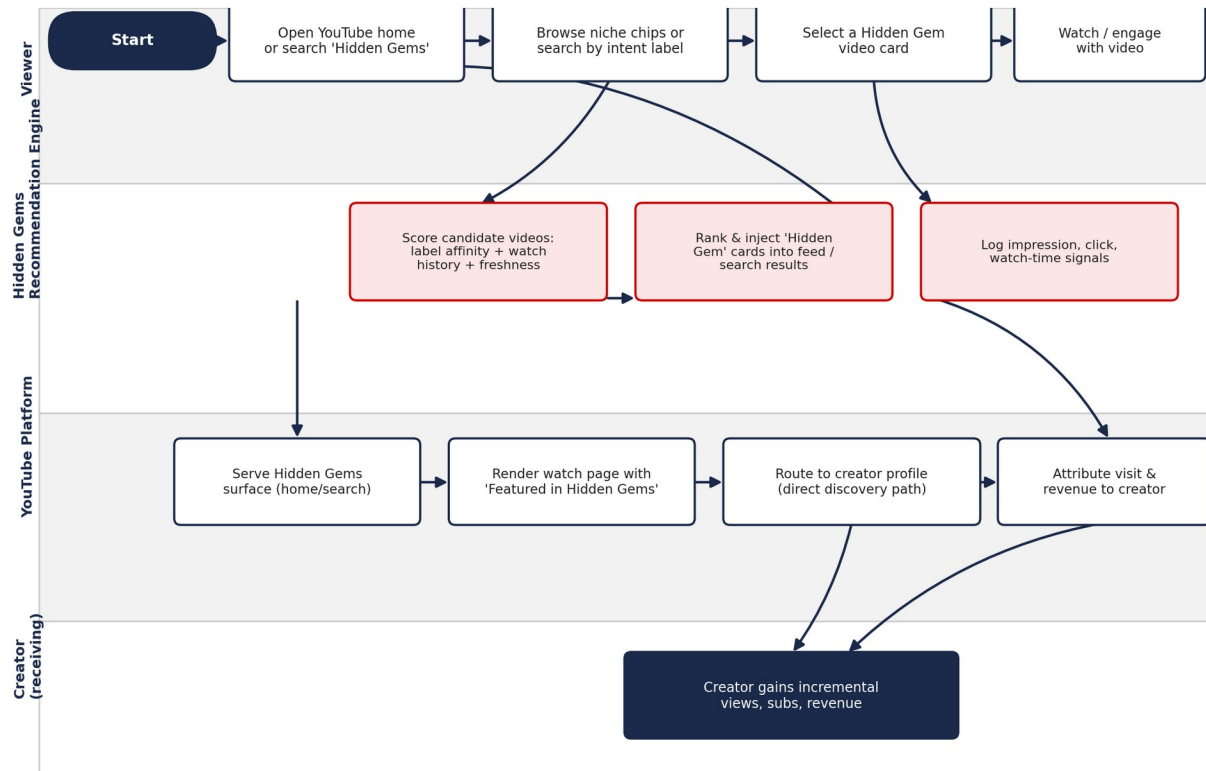


Figure 2 — Viewer Discovery & Attribution Process (Swimlane)

3.1 Step Narrative

9. Viewer opens the YouTube home tab or searches “Hidden Gems” / a niche term (FR-M3-01, FR-M4-01).
10. Viewer browses niche preference chips or searches by an intent label (FR-M3-02, FR-M4-01).
11. The Recommendation Engine scores candidate videos using label affinity, watch history, and freshness signals (FR-M5-01).
12. The Recommendation Engine ranks and injects Hidden Gem cards into the home feed and/or search results (FR-M5-01, FR-M4-01).
13. The platform serves the Hidden Gems surface to the viewer (home tab or search results).
14. Viewer selects a Hidden Gem video card.
15. The platform renders the watch page, including the “Featured in Hidden Gems” badge and related-gems module (FR-M6-01, FR-M6-02).
16. Viewer watches/engages with the video; the Recommendation Engine logs impression, click, and watch-time signals (FR-M7-01).
17. The platform routes the viewer to the creator's profile when they follow the direct discovery path (FR-M6-03).
18. The platform attributes the resulting visit and any associated revenue event to the originating creator (FR-M7-01, FR-M7-02).

19. The creator gains incremental views, subscribers, and/or revenue, closing the loop back into the growth flywheel (Process Map 3).

4. Process Map 3 — End-to-End Discovery Loop (Growth Flywheel)

This high-level, cross-functional view illustrates how the Creator Labeling Process (Process Map 1) and Viewer Discovery Process (Process Map 2) connect into a compounding growth loop, which is the mechanism behind the program's North Star Metric.

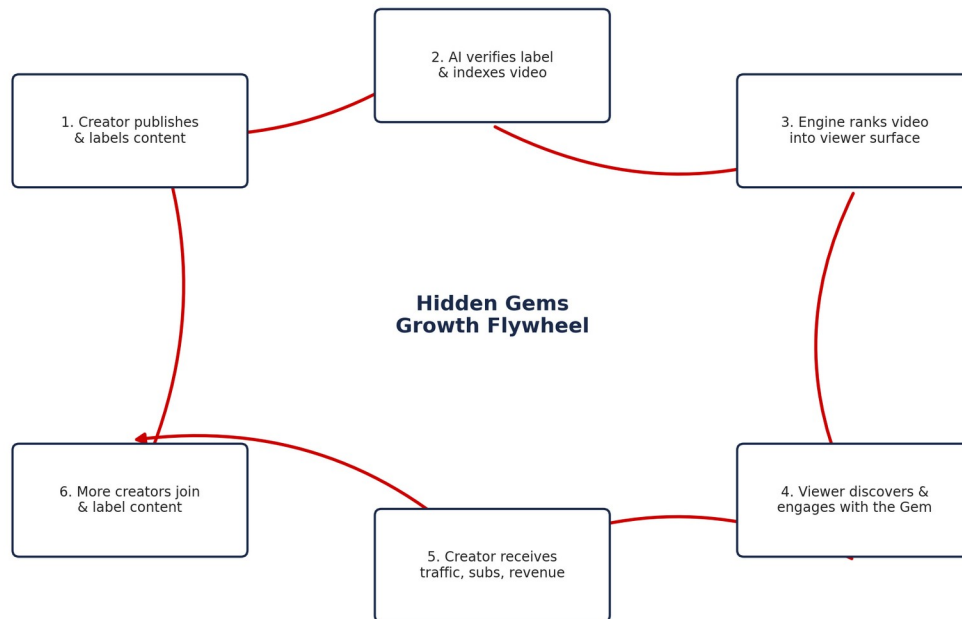


Figure 3 — End-to-End Discovery Loop (Cross-Functional Overview)

4.1 Loop Narrative

- Step 1 → 2: Creator publishes and labels content (Process Map 1, Steps 1–3).
- Step 2 → 3: AI verifies the label and indexes the video (Process Map 1, Steps 4–7).
- Step 3 → 4: The Recommendation Engine ranks the video into the viewer surface (Process Map 2, Steps 3–5).
- Step 4 → 5: The viewer discovers and engages with the Gem (Process Map 2, Steps 6–9).
- Step 5 → 6: The creator receives attributed traffic, subscribers, and revenue (Process Map 2, Steps 10–11).
- Step 6 → 1: Positive outcomes attract more creators to join and label content, restarting the loop with greater supply.

5. Process Map 4 — Label Moderation Exception Process

This supporting process handles labels that the AI Label Verification Engine cannot confidently approve or reject outright (referenced from Process Map 1, Step 5).

Step	Actor	Activity	Traces to
1	AI Verification Engine	Flags label as needs-review (confidence below threshold)	FR-M2-03
2	Trust & Safety Moderator	Reviews flagged label, associated video, and confidence score in moderation queue	FR-M8-01
3	Trust & Safety Moderator	Approves, rejects, or edits the label	FR-M8-02
4	Platform	Logs decision with actor, timestamp, and rationale for audit	FR-M2-05, NFR-07
5	Trust & Safety Moderator	If repeated violations are detected for the creator, suspends labeling privileges	FR-M8-03
6	Platform	Notifies creator of final decision and, where applicable, suspension terms	FR-M2-02

6. Process Ownership (RACI Summary)

Detailed RACI matrices for each process are maintained in the Supporting Artifacts document. Primary process owners are summarized below.

Process	Process Owner
Creator Labeling Process	Creator Studio Product Team
Viewer Discovery & Attribution Process	Discovery & Recommendations Product Team
End-to-End Discovery Loop	Hidden Gems Program / Product Management
Label Moderation Exception Process	Trust & Safety Team